

A Few Fundamentals of Ruby Programming

Ruby is an open source, general programming language that has been influenced by Perl, Smalltalk, Eiffel, Ada and Lisp. It has an elegant syntax, and is focused on simplicity and productivity. Ruby is easy to learn and works on the principle of 'writing more with less'.



Programming languages and spoken languages are quite similar; both have one or more categories. A few programming language categories you might have heard of include imperative, object-oriented, functional or logic-based. Ruby is a powerful and dynamic open source, object-oriented language created by a developer known as Matz, and runs on almost all platforms such as Linux, Windows, MacOS, etc. Every programmer's first computer program is usually the 'Hello World Program', as shown below.

C++	Ruby
<pre>#include <iostream> using namespace std; int main() { cout << "Hello World" << endl; return 0; }</pre>	<pre>puts "Hello World"</pre>

Are you, now, more interested in Ruby? Ruby is one of the easiest languages to learn as it focuses on the productivity of program development. It is a server-side scripting language

and has features that are similar to those of Smalltalk, Perl and Python.

Ruby and Ruby on Rails

Ruby is a programming language while Ruby on Rails, or simply Rails, is a software library that extends the Ruby programming language. Rails is a software framework dependent on the Ruby programming language for creating Web applications.

Web applications can also be written in Ruby, but writing a fully functional Web application from scratch in Ruby is a daunting task. Rails is a collection of pre-written code that makes writing Web applications easier and helps make them simpler to maintain.

Still confused? Think of how a pizza is made. You simply spread the tomato sauce on the pizza base, top it with the veggies and spread the grated cheese. But where did the pizza base come from? It's easier to get it from the grocery store instead of baking your own using flour and water. In this case, the Ruby programming language is the flour and water. By learning Ruby, you are a step closer to Rails and can create Web applications like Twitter one day.